

These, and many others of like significance, are in everybody's mouth. But, as generally happens, the more beautiful the thought, the more likely it is to have been borrowed. Gray's most remarkable poem, the "Elegy in a Country Churchyard," is said to have been picked out, thought by thought, if not word by word, from other poets. The very first line,—

"The curfew tolls the knell of parting day,"

has been adopted from the following passage in Dante's "Purgatory :"—

"Se ode squilla di lontano
Che paja 'l giorno pianger che si muore."